Autocomplete Poetry Teacher Notes

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Knowledge and Technology • 20-30 min

Category	Knowledge and Technology	**Time**	20-30 min
Difficulty	Medium	**ID**	autocomplete-poetry

Big idea: Prediction can imitate creativity.

Overview

Students explore the difference between prediction, creativity and understanding.

Student Prompt

Inspect Autocomplete Poetry Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Autocomplete Poetry Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Students write a poem using only suggested next words from a shared prompt. Rank, sort, or audit this output. Identify which rule, ranking signal, or interface choice shaped your judgement.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Autocomplete Poetry Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Two poems compared: one written by intention, one guided by autocomplete. Rank, sort, or audit this output. Identify which rule, ranking signal, or interface choice shaped your judgement.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Autocomplete Poetry Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: A reflection on whether fluency signals authorship or knowledge. Rank, sort, or audit this output. Identify which rule, ranking signal, or interface choice shaped your judgement.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Prediction can imitate creativity.

Actual Lesson Questions and Key

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Autocomplete Poetry Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Autocomplete Poetry Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.
6	Does pattern prediction count as understanding?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how prediction can imitate creativity.

• Strong response: separates observation from inference.

• Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.

• Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.

• Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Setup Checklist

• Prepare a starter stimulus using: Students write a poem using only suggested next words from a shared prompt.

• Print or project the student response grid before the activity begins.

• Plan a private first-response moment before any group discussion.

Ready-to-Use Examples

• Students write a poem using only suggested next words from a shared prompt.

• Two poems compared: one written by intention, one guided by autocomplete.

• A reflection on whether fluency signals authorship or knowledge.

Suggested Timing

Stage	Teacher move	Watch for
1	Students write the first line of a poem or reflection.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
2	They use autocomplete to continue it for six to ten lines.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
3	Compare the result with a human-written continuation.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
4	Students annotate where the machine is patterned, surprising, empty or meaningful.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
Debrief	Move from the activity result to a TOK knowledge question.	Students distinguishing method, evidence, interpretation, and overclaiming.

Teacher Language

• Write your first judgement before we discuss it; the first answer is useful evidence.

• Separate what you noticed from what you inferred.

• What would make this knowledge claim more reliable?

Common Misconceptions

• Students may treat a tool's output as neutral because it feels automatic.

• Students may focus only on user error and miss design incentives or hidden rules.

Assessment Look-Fors

• Identifies the rule, design choice, or incentive shaping knowledge.

• Distinguishes access to information from justified knowledge.

Differentiation and Adaptations

• Short lesson: use only the first example, one response grid, and one debrief question.

• Long lesson: add a second round where students revise the method and compare outcomes.

• Low-tech option: run with printed cards, sticky notes, and a board tally.

Extension Tasks

• Design a second version of the activity that tests the same knowledge issue in another AOK.

• Find a real-world example where the same knowledge problem matters outside the classroom.

• Write a 150-word TOK exhibition-style commentary using the activity as the object context.

Related Activities

• Algorithmic Feed Simulation

• Search Engine Ranking Game

• AI Hallucination Courtroom